

IS IT AI?

Student Sheet



Calculator	Mum's TikTok For You Page
Spotify personalised playlist	Smoke alarm
Face ID	Microwave timer
Google Maps directions	Amazon Alexa giving us a recipe
Traffic lights changing on timers	A robot trained to assemble tables
Tesla braking for pedestrian	A vending machine giving you change
Google showing search results	Siri suggesting a restaurant

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Teacher Guide



AI NOT AI DEBATABLE

Calculator <i>NOT AI. Follows fixed rules — it does exactly what you type, every time. No learning, no patterns.</i>	Mum's TikTok For You Page <i>AI. Learns from what you watch, like, and skip to predict what to show next.</i>
Spotify personalised playlist <i>AI. Analyses your listening history and patterns from millions of users to predict songs you'll enjoy.</i>	Smoke alarm <i>NOT AI. A sensor detects smoke above a fixed threshold and triggers an alarm — a simple precoded rule.</i>
Face ID <i>AI. Uses a neural network trained on thousands of faces to recognise yours, even in different lighting.</i>	Microwave timer <i>NOT AI. Counts down a set time and stops — a fixed rule with no learning involved.</i>
Google Maps directions <i>AI. Learns from real-time traffic data and millions of past trips to predict and reroute the fastest path.</i>	Amazon Alexa giving us a recipe <i>AI. Uses natural language processing to understand your question and retrieve a relevant answer.</i>
Traffic lights changing on timers <i>NOT AI. Switches on a fixed schedule — it doesn't observe or adapt to traffic conditions.</i>	A robot trained to assemble tables <i>DEBATABLE. The word "trained" suggests AI, but most factory robots follow precoded steps. Ask: does it learn, or just repeat?</i>
Tesla braking for pedestrian <i>DEBATABLE. Basic braking uses a sensor and a fixed rule (not AI). Full self-driving systems that identify what the obstacle is use AI.</i>	A vending machine giving you change <i>NOT AI. Calculates change using fixed maths — no pattern recognition or learning involved.</i>
Google showing search results <i>DEBATABLE. Basic keyword matching is not AI, but Google uses AI to rank results based on what people click on.</i>	Siri suggesting a restaurant <i>AI. Uses natural language understanding and learns from your habits and location to make personalised suggestions.</i>